

JUST A GIRL

ISSUE 1



COVER ART BY ALIYAH TUNJANO, RONNIE CALDERON



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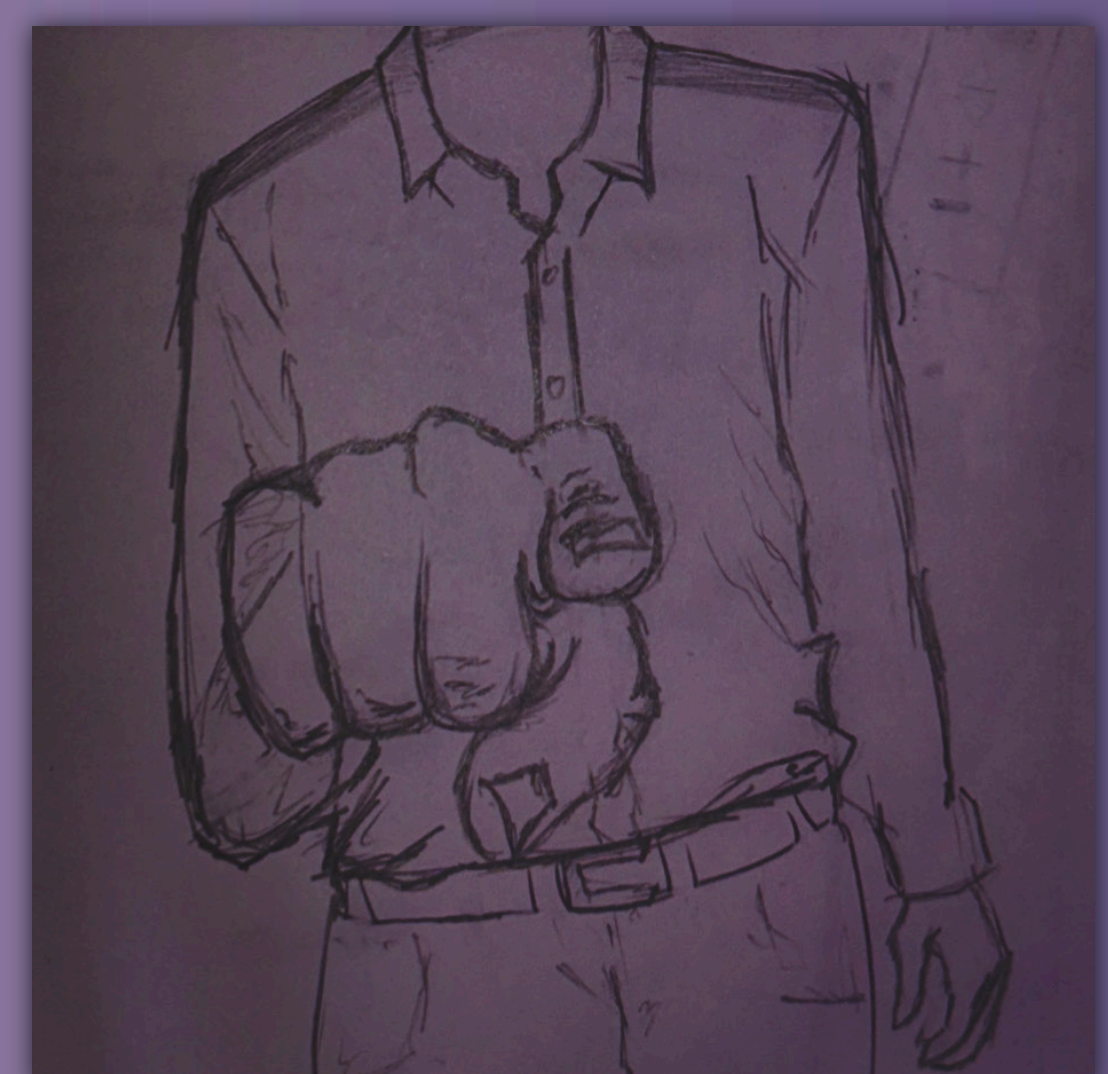
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Things We Can't Say - Blackout Poetry
After a letter from Vita Sackville-West to
Virginia Woolf, Long Barn Weald Sevenoaks,
October 11, 1928

Carolina Gutfreund

@Ro_Writing

My darling,

I am in no fit state [redacted] cold [redacted] opinions [redacted]
[redacted] on the telephone [redacted] things do not exist in [redacted]
connection [redacted] not yet. [redacted] I can't
say anything [redacted]

[redacted]
Virginia, I [redacted] don't know what to say. [redacted] I [redacted] am [redacted] wrong?
[redacted] you [redacted]
[redacted] complete [redacted] sober
labour [redacted] never [redacted] faltered [redacted] execution.
[redacted] come to me [redacted] fast [redacted] trip over each other [redacted] I lose
[redacted] there is so much I want to say, [redacted] I
can only go back to [redacted] be [redacted] ill [redacted]

[redacted]
[redacted] shaken, [redacted] useless [redacted] but [redacted]
[redacted] touch me [redacted] personally [redacted]
[redacted] I don't know what to say [redacted] I feel [redacted]
[redacted] alone [redacted]
dark [redacted] chest full [redacted] Darling, [redacted]

[redacted]
[redacted] Really [redacted] I can't [redacted]
[redacted] tell you verbally. [redacted] you [redacted] think [redacted] me too
confused and [redacted]
[redacted] direct [redacted]

[redacted]
I should [redacted] go [redacted] phrases
scattered about,

Things We Can't Say - Blackout Poetry
After a letter from Vita Sackville-West to
Virginia Woolf, Long Barn Weald Sevenoaks,
October 11, 1928

Carolina Gutfreund

@Ro_Writing

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED] blind [REDACTED] it is now 5 o'clock [REDACTED]
[REDACTED] I will try [REDACTED] more [REDACTED]
tomorrow. It is your fault, [REDACTED]
[REDACTED] all my faculties have dropped [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED] awful [REDACTED]
[REDACTED] I [REDACTED]
got [REDACTED] fixed in my head [REDACTED]
I [REDACTED] resigned [REDACTED] to wait [REDACTED] But [REDACTED] I [REDACTED]
[REDACTED] binding, [REDACTED] and
utterly appalled [REDACTED] But [REDACTED] I [REDACTED]
[REDACTED] misunderstood. [REDACTED] I will write again
tomorrow, [REDACTED] I am [REDACTED] writing against
time [REDACTED] shaken [REDACTED]
[REDACTED] - I confess, - I am in love [REDACTED] a
complication I had not foreseen. [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

Peppered Green

Joanna Dora Fishman

@wildiguana

They tell me I am a woman
and then pepper me with paint dust.
Pink walls adorn my childhood bedroom,
prosed out of me at a young age.
“You are our little princess,” they tell me -
strangeness in their eyes -
feeding me pixie tales, dolls rocked in my hands,
harnessing my inner ‘mother’?

Did they ask me if I wanted to be pink?
Green Crayola-stained hands, flustered at my sides,
I grow old of this story early.

Did they ask me if I wanted to be a princess - their
princess?
Ears pierced, thin shape,
I was praised for hollowing my ribs,
to make room for their pink,
prosed out of me at a young age.
“You are our little princess,” they tell me -
comfort in their eyes -
cradling me with kitchen chores and household
responsibilities,
while my brothers played in the yard.
I grow old of tidy hands early.

They tell me I am a woman,
and expect that word to story obedience -
orderly, quiet, complacent, maternal,
owned.

They tell me I am a woman,
and yet to me that means a separate thing.

Peppered Green

Joanna Dora Fishman

@wildiguana

For
I am a little dragon,
young and fierce - hear my roar.
Rosy cheeks, streaked with dirt and sun,
coupled with sweaty palms,
unraveling laughter, loosening the seams
of the girlhood they tried to tailor around me.

And I am a wild a thing -
for
I run with the cowgirls and zookeepers;
with the girl who swings her bat at the sky,
playing
green, muddied, chaotic, driven, unyielding,
devoted to herself
till the grass marks her knees green.
Belly full and round, I love to hug my own warmth.

And I paint the walls green.



ART BY ABBY LEEDS / @ABBYLEEDSS



To Die On The Cross- Dara Sky / @daramustdie

I Know

Emily Strawn

I Know

Your every movement
as you roll beneath my skin.

How could I not be dazzled by you?

I laugh, sometimes cry.
Sure, I'm scared of what's to come,
But it's not because I'm scared of
you.

I see you
Shifting my insides to give you
everything
You are nothing but extraordinary

Just over a pound but I can see you
And you are already so much more
Than I could ever be

What if I'm not enough for you?

But I know you
Your undefined flutters of grandeur
and glee
The place where your heart was
etched out of me.

I Know

Emily Strawn

I love you

Barely a pound but I can feel you
I haven't even met you yet
But I'll shred myself into confetti

I'll do anything to make you happy.

Large for gestation, the doctor
said.

I am awed by your very existence
Stretching inside of me

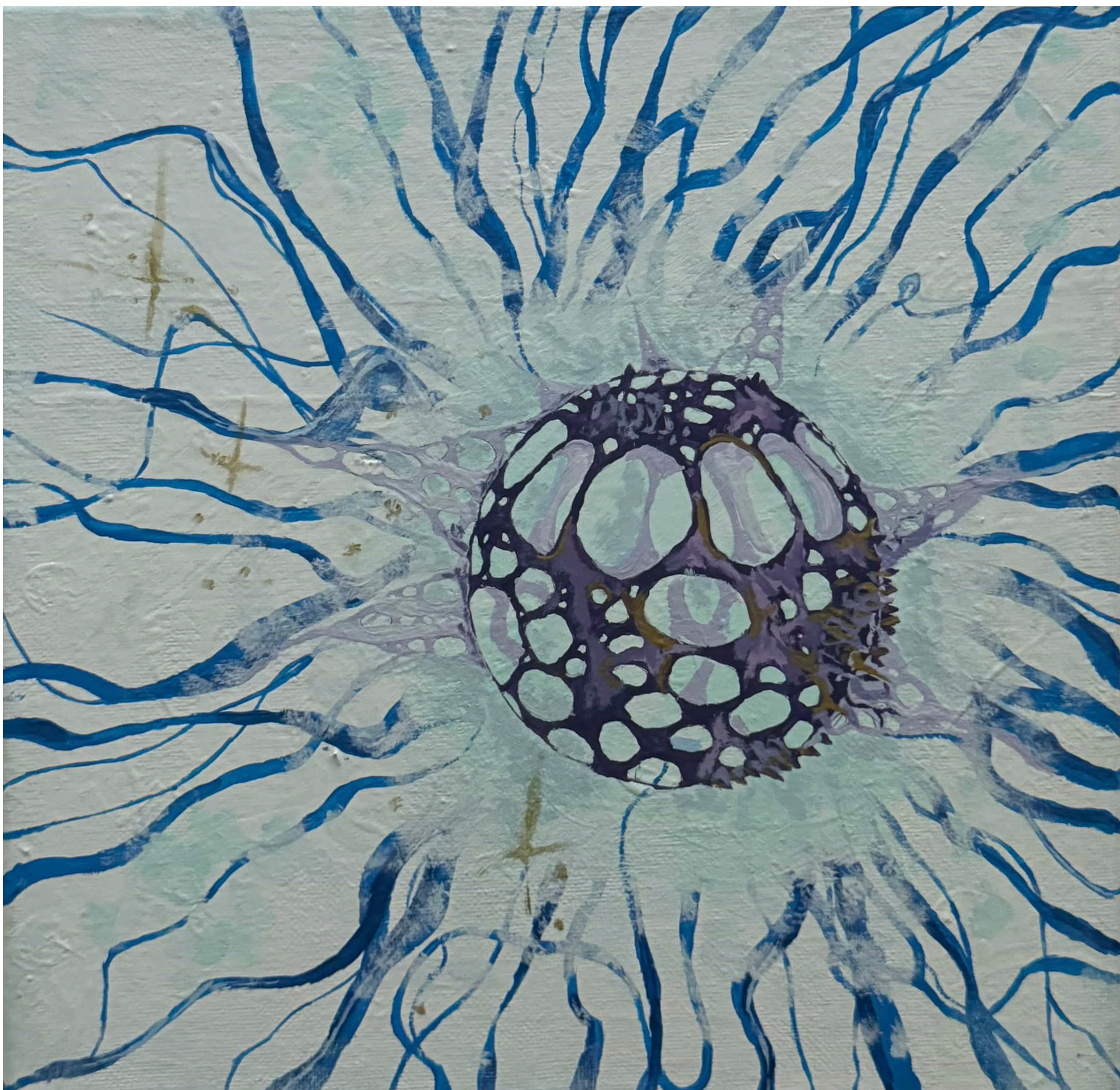
I can see you
I feel you

I could never give another
Your you-ness

I can only give you all of my
me-ness

But you?
I can feel you
Becoming bigger, brighter, better

Than all the stars you came from.



Art by Sara Ellison - @sm3llison

Girl Fight

Michelle Plyam

@michelleplyam

no euphemisms could stitch
the threads we left unknotted.
they will remain paralyzed in the air
like the words we never could speak,
or the apologies i could never even
write,
or the plans we made that can never
happen.

the scant hope of our resolve died with
you
at only twenty one.

you were a big sister whose age i will
soon surpass,
one i can only access in photos and
songs we shared.

i would do anything to just argue with
you again.
the grief began as silence, yet your
mother is burying you now,
and i still hear your echo in each
melody i showed you.

your absence is the lost thread
that goes through me as if i were a
sewing needle.

everything i do is stitched with its
color.



Self Portrait with Cropped Hair by Frida Kahlo (1940)

Noelia Trejo

With silver scissors in your right hand,
you chopped off your hair,

chunks scattered around the terracotta
floor. The braids you once cherished,

that he cherished, are no longer
associated with you or him. The thick
braid lies heavy

on top of your thigh, like realization
weighing you when you caught him

with your sister. The many women he's
been with you could excuse,

but your sister? Your sister? No. That's
why you cut your hair.

The slicked back hair fits you, more
than the large black suit jacket and the
maroon shirt

with its rosy buttons hiding your thin,
disabled frame. Roses are only beautiful

when you take out the thorns. You were
always full of thorns and broken bones.

Self Portrait with Cropped Hair by Frida Kahlo (1940)

Noelia Trejo

He failed to notice that, but what about now, cross-dressing in his clothes? Do you feel

like a man? Do you feel like him? You feel like a man more than he ever was.

But how will you prove it is a question that comes to mind.

With this self-portrait, you proved your worth by cutting him and the memories of him off.

I imagine you getting up from your chair, walking out of your studio, listening to the clicks

of your black heeled shoes on the pavement and enter some seedy bar to find a new paramour. Did you feel like a man when you whispered sweet nothings to some man or woman?

Did you use your hands to explore them with an artistic eye or the sensual one, like the ones he had with your sister?

Self Portrait with Cropped Hair by Frida Kahlo (1940)



Noelia Trejo

Did your body cry out to you to return back to him while looking at your paramour, or was the body crying out for more? You can only stroke their hair for so long before you go back to your lonely studio and look at your self-portrait.

I stare into your vacant eyes, wondering if you are looking at me or over my shoulder.

Can you look at me? You don't have to. I can see the way your mouth is turned downward,

the small wrinkle gives away the pain, disgust, and betrayal that Diego caused you.

Despite it all, you returned to him, and he to you. You made him feel that pain as he watched

you go with other men and women. That exhilaration must have felt great,

better than the painkillers or the rush of an orgasm with a man that isn't Diego.

Self Portrait with Cropped Hair by Frida Kahlo (1940)

Noelia Trejo

Whenever the urge to cut my hair short
like yours grows each day, I hear the
song:

Mira que si te quise, fué por el pelo,
Ahora que estás pelona, ya no te quiero

because people only like you when they
want something from you, like hair.

Maybe one day I will take some silver
scissors and cut off my hair, looking at
the mirror

while wearing a suit too big for my
thin, soon-to-be disabled body and think
of you

with my slicked back hair.

Maybe I'll look like you, with your
thick unibrow and mustache, small golden
earring,

and your natural blush. Maybe I want to
feel like a man like you did, pelona.

I'll make sure to prove it, even if
people don't like me anymore.

ABC's For Girls

Raquel Gerena

@raquellegerena

Always be kind
Be grateful
Carry yourself with grace
Don't forget to smile
Educate yourself, but not too much
Follow the word
Give yourself willingly
Have children for the world
Invest your time wisely
Just be grateful
Keep your legs closed
Love loudly
Make yourself smaller
Never disobey
Overcompensate, but not too much
Put on makeup
Quit complaining
Really, be grateful
Show off your body
Tailor your life to others
Use your body to get what you want
Vilifying men, really?
Whore
X the ex
You're doing it wrong
Zaftig isn't a body type to have
Zing! You're 35, time's up
You need to eat more, but not too much
X-ray, no it's a mammogram

ABC's For Girls

Raquel Gerena

@raquellegerena

Well, what were you wearing?
 Voices shouldn't be heard
 Understand that it's your fault
 Talk like a lady
 Stay pretty
 Remember to be a good mother
 Quit complaining, be grateful
 Plastic in your face, really?
 Oh, be grateful
 Never show fear
 Make yourself smaller
 Lead with strength, but not too much
 Keep yourself in shape
 Justify what they did to you
 Inhale, exhale
 Have a good time, always
 Grasp the fact that you'll never win
 Fight for what's right, but not too much
 Entertain men, whore
 Don't judge others so much
 Contribute to society
 Be grateful that you get to
 Always be grateful

